

March

31

Earth Hour

More than 2 million homes and 2,000 businesses switched their lights off for an hour to help save energy during the first Earth Hour event, held in Sydney, Australia.

2007

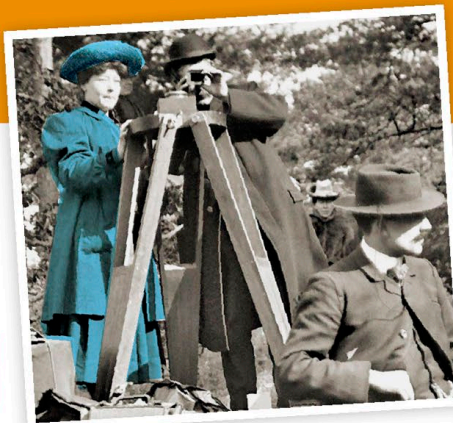


Also on this day

1854 **Under threat of force,** Japan opened its ports to US trade ships, ending centuries of isolation from the outside world.

1870 **Thomas Mundy Peterson** was the first Black American to vote in the US elections, after a new law allowed citizens of all races to vote.

1913 **A musical recital in Vienna** – later named the Skandalkonzert (“scandal concert”) – was so unmelodic that the audience rioted to make it stop.



1896

Female director

Trailblazing French film director Alice Guy-Blaché released

the short silent film *La Fée aux Choux* (“The Cabbage Fairy”), about a fairy who makes babies from cabbages. It was the first film ever directed by a woman.

Born this day

1971 **Ewan McGregor**, Scottish actor. He has appeared in a diverse range of dramas and musicals, and has starred as the Jedi Knight Obi-Wan Kenobi in the *Star Wars* series.

1889

Eiffel Tower

The grand opening of the Eiffel Tower took place in Paris, France. Named after its designer Gustave Eiffel, the iron tower consists of 18,000 parts. Standing 324 m (1,063 ft) tall, it was the world's tallest building until 1930.

